

A2

GRAMMAR LESSON · PAST TENSES

Past Continuous vs Past Simple

A long action in the past and the short action that interrupts it.

Hikaye Zamanı - Geçmiş Zaman Farkı

QUICK UNDERSTANDING

Bir cümlede genellikle **iki geçmiş olay birlikte anlatılır**: biri devam ederken (Past Continuous) diğeri aniden gerçekleşir (Past Simple) ve onu keser. Bu iki zamanı doğru seçmek, hangi eylemin "uzun/sürekli", hangisinin "kısa/ani" olduğunu anlamaktan geçer.

The Structure

Formula

while + Past Continuous, Past Continuous (iki eş zamanlı eylem)

Past Continuous + when + Past Simple (uzun eylem + onu kesen ani olay)

while genelde "süren" eylemi tanıtır; when genelde "ani" olayı tanıtır.

Affirmative / Negative / Question

AFFIRMATIVE

Subject + was/were + V-ing + when
+ Subject + V2

I was sleeping when you texted me.

NEGATIVE

Subject + wasn't/weren't + V-ing +
when...

He wasn't paying attention when
the teacher spoke.

QUESTION

What were you doing when...?

What were you doing when the
alarm went off?

Word Order

while/when cümlesi başta veya sonda olabilir; başta ise virgülle ayrılır.

- **While** I was walking home, it started to rain. — Eve yürürken yağmur yağmaya başladı.
- It started to rain **while** I was walking home. — Ben eve yürürken yağmur yağmaya başladı.

How It Works

When do we use it?

- **Devam eden bir eylemi ani bir olayın kesmesi**: I was studying when the power went out.
- **while ile iki devam eden eylemi eş zamanlı bağlamak**: While she was cooking, he was cleaning the house.
- **when ile ani bir olayı, devam eden bir eylemin ortasına yerleştirmek**: The baby started crying when the music stopped.
- **Bir olayın tam sırasında ne olduğunu vurgulamak**: What were you doing when the accident happened?

When DON'T we use it?

İki eylem de kısa ve ardışık iki fiili de Past Continuous YAPMA — ardışık, tamamlanmış olaylar için ikisi de Past Simple olmalı.

✗ I was opening the door and I was seeing him. → ✓ I opened the door and I saw him.

while'dan sonra Past Simple KULLANMA (devam eden eylem için): ✗ While I cooked, he arrived. → ✓ While I was cooking, he arrived.

Short Answers

Bu yapıda genelde tam cümle cevap verilir, ama kısa cevap için her fiil kendi zamanına göre cevaplanır:
"Were you sleeping?" → "Yes, I was." / "Did it ring?" → "Yes, it did."

Türkçe Mantığı

Zihninde şu sırayla ilerle:

TÜRKÇEDE NE DEMEK İSTİYORUM? → "Ben duş alırken telefon çaldı." → HANGİSİ UZUN SÜRÜYORDU, HANGİSİ ANI? → duş almak = uzun süren, telefon çalması = ani → UZUN OLAN → Past Continuous / ANI OLAN → Past Simple → CÜMLE → "I was taking a shower when the phone rang."

Examples

KESİLEN EYLEM KALIBI (WHEN)

- I was washing the dishes when the doorbell rang. — Bulaşık yıkarken kapı zili çaldı.
- She was driving to work when she saw the accident. — İşe giderken kazayı gördü.
- We were watching the match when the lights went out. — Maçı izlerken elektrikler kesildi.

EŞ ZAMANLI EYLEMLER (WHILE)

- While Elif was reading, her brother was playing video games. — Elif kitap okurken kardeşi video oyunu oynuyordu.
- While I was working on the report, my colleague was preparing the slides. — Ben raporu hazırlarken meslektaşım slaytları hazırlıyordu.

KARŞILAŞTIRMA / SIRALI OLAYLAR

- He finished his coffee and left the café. — Kahvesini bitirdi ve kafeden ayrıldı. (iki ardışık olay = Past Simple)
- I was cleaning the kitchen when my phone buzzed. — Mutfağı temizlerken telefonum titredi. (uzun + kesen olay)
- What were you doing when the news broke? — Haber çıktığında ne yapıyordun?
- While the kids were sleeping, we were talking quietly in the kitchen. — Çocuklar uyurken biz mutfakta sessizce konuşuyorduk.
- The car broke down while we were driving to the coast. — Sahile giderken araba bozuldu.

Compare & Notice

Compare With

while Genelde devam eden (uzun) bir eylemi tanıtır. While I was cooking...	when Genelde ani, tamamlanmış bir olayı tanıtır. ...when the phone rang.
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Visual Timeline

Timeline: uzun eylem sürüyordu (was doing) · ani olay onu kesti (did)

Common Mistakes

✗ I opened the door and I was seeing my sister.	✓ I opened the door and saw my sister.
WHY? İki eylem de kısa, ardışık ve tamamlanmışsa ikisi de Past Simple olur; "see" gibi ani bir eylemi Past Continuous yapmak yanlıştır.	
✗ While I cooked, the phone was ringing.	✓ While I was cooking, the phone rang.
WHY? "while" genelde devam eden (uzun) eylemi tanıtır, ani olan olayı değil; ani olay when + Past Simple ile verilir.	
✗ When I was arriving home, I was calling my mother.	✓ When I arrived home, I called my mother. / When I got home, I was calling my mother.
WHY? "arrive" gibi ani bir fiil genellikle Past Simple ile kurulur; iki fiili de Past Continuous yapmak eylemlerin sırasını belirsizleştirir.	
✗ When she was leaving the room, everyone was clapping.	✓ When she left the room, everyone was clapping.
WHY? "when" cümlecisindeki eylem genellikle ani/tamamlanmış olur (left); devam eden tepki ise Past Continuous (was clapping) ile verilir.	

Practice

Name: _____

Date: _____

Score: _____ / 17

PART A · QUICK CHECK

1. I _____ when the power went out.

- a) study b) was studying c) studied at d) were studying

2. Find the mistake and correct it.

While I ^A cooked ^B, the phone rang. ^C

Correction: _____

3. I opened the door and _____ my sister.

- a) was seeing b) see c) have seen d) saw

PART B · PRACTICE

4. What _____ you doing when the accident happened?

- a) was b) did c) were d) are

5. She _____ her leg while she was skiing. (break)

6. While she was cooking, he _____ the house. (clean)

7. Which sentence is correct?

- a) When I arrived home, I called my mother.
b) When I was arriving home, I was calling my mother.
c) When I arrived home, I was call my mother.
d) When I was arrive home, I called my mother.

8. You tell a friend about a funny moment in class.

Which sentence is best?

- a) The teacher was writing on the board when a bird was flown in.
b) The teacher writes on the board when a bird flew in.
c) The teacher wrote on the board when a bird was flying in.
d) The teacher was writing on the board when a bird flew in.

9. "When I arrived, she was leaving." What happened?

- a) She left after I arrived, much later.
b) She didn't leave.
c) She was in the middle of leaving when I arrived.
d) She left before I arrived.

PART C · FINAL CHECK

10. The baby started crying when the music _____ .

- a) stops b) was stopping c) stopped d) stopping

11. We _____ dinner when our guests arrived.

- a) have b) had had c) are having d) were having

12. I _____ a shower when you called me. (take)

13. Find the mistake and correct it.

I ^A was hearing ^B a noise while I was sleeping. ^C

Correction: _____

14. _____ I was waiting for the bus, I met an old friend.

a) While

b) For

c) During

d) When was

15. Your teacher asks what happened yesterday.

Which sentence is correct?

a) I walked to school when I was seeing a fire truck.

b) I was walking to school when I was see a fire truck.

c) I was walking to school when I saw a fire truck.

d) I was walk to school when I saw a fire truck.

16. "While I was reading, my brother was playing games." What does it mean?

a) Reading happened first, then playing.

b) Only one action happened.

c) Both actions were happening at the same time.

d) Playing interrupted reading.

17. Join with "when": "I was sleeping. The alarm rang."

I was sleeping _____ .

Answer Key

Kısa açıklamalar, her cevabın hangi kurala dayandığını gösterir.

PART A · QUICK CHECK

1. **b) was studying** — Uzun eylem → past continuous; ani olay → past simple.
2. **B — cooked → was cooking** — while + süren eylem → past continuous.
3. **d) saw** — Art arda iki kısa eylem → past simple.

PART B · PRACTICE

4. **c) were** — Kesilen eylem sorusu: What were you doing when...?
5. **broke** — Ani olay → past simple.
6. **was cleaning** — Aynı anda süren iki eylem → ikisi de past continuous.
7. **a) When I arrived home, I called my mother.** — Art arda eylemler → past simple + past simple.
8. **d) The teacher was writing on the board when a bird flew in.** — Uzun eylem (was writing) + kesen ani olay (flew).
9. **c) She was in the middle of leaving when I arrived.** — Past continuous: ayrılma eylemi o sırada sürüyordu.

PART C · FINAL CHECK

10. **c) stopped** — Ani olay → past simple.
11. **d) were having** — Kesilen uzun eylem → were having.
12. **was taking** — Kesilen eylem → was taking.
13. **B — was hearing → heard** — Kısa, ani olay → past simple: I heard a noise.
14. **a) While** — while + süren eylem.
15. **c) I was walking to school when I saw a fire truck.** — Uzun eylem + onu kesen kısa eylem.
16. **c) Both actions were happening at the same time.** — while + iki past continuous → eş zamanlı eylemler.
17. **I was sleeping when the alarm rang.** — Uzun eylem + when + kısa eylem.

Bu dersin interaktif versiyonu (anında geri bildirimli alıştırılmalar):

<https://abonlinenglish.school/grammar/a2/past-continuous-vs-past-simple>